Unit 22 - Developing Computer Games
Assignment 1 - Social Impact of Gaming

Introduction

Scenario / Vocational Context - *As an expert gamer, you have been asked by the Department of Health to help them understand more about gaming, and the social impacts thereof.*

Task 1

(U22:P1) - Explain the impact of computer games on society

Task description - *List positive and negative issues relating to the effect of playing computer games. Your brief descriptions should be in the following three sections:*

1.1 Concerns for the Individual

Three potential impacts on individual game players related to any of: excess playing time, social isolation, cost, separation from reality, education

1.2 Benefits for the Individual:

Three potential impacts on individual game players related to any of: hand-eye coordination, brain training, thinking and strategy skills, future impact, impact on 'mainstream' application development

1.3 Knock On Effect on Society:

Three potential impacts on individual game players related to any of: effect on families, businesses, the health service and other groups that result from the positive and negative effects on players.

Introduction

In the modern day, video games are now a part of a lot of young adults lives. Gaming has grown over the years, leaving people to debate whether video games have become almost, if not as big, as the film and TV industry.

Graphics have come on leaps and bounds and they now are looking more photorealistic every day. Which can attract a lot of people since visual aspects is what attracts people, especially when advertised. Meaning that video games are gaining more players each day, with the help of the popularity of the internet and its grasp on video games.

However, video games is also increasingly high profile topic with parents worrying too many children are spending too much time playing computer games. Making most the parents and other individuals questioning whether video games are actually causing a good or bad impact to society as a whole.

Concerns for the Individual

Excess playing time

Playing time is a very important concern when talking about video games, due to the fact that some people can be addicted to playing video games. Which can cause the player to stay up all night, causing sleep deprivation.

According to studies, the average player spends about 3 hours a day playing video games. Meaning that they spend 21 hours weekly gaming, which can pretty excessive with the thinking that so much more could be achieved in that time.

Also this could affect their everyday behaviour in the real world towards others. What I mean by this is that the time spent playing games can be a problem depending on how the player manages their lifestyle. Basically, playing games too much could have an adverse effect on the player's health.

For example, their eyes could be strained if they play a game for too long. That being said, all games will have disclaimers and they will inform the player that spending too much on the game it will be harmful of their health. Making it the responsibility of the individual to take regular breaks and ensure they are taking the correct amount of time before reconvening.

Overall, the time spent playing videos can have an effect on the amount of time a player is able to do other activities within the day. For instance, the time spent playing games could be overeating on the time that should be sleeping or doing something such as coursework.

Social isolation

Social isolation is also another big concern with video game. The amount of time people spend gaming leaves them very socially isolated, which could lead to a lack of friends and then losing confidence with communicating with other people.

In previous generations of gaming, playing computer game involved a singular person sitting in front on of the computer in most cases alone. Although there are games which are up to four local players sometimes these just wasn’t applicable. This would tend to mean a player would be sat on their own in their own home.

However, nowadays this isn’t the case as such. Yes, players are still playing at home but the online community, including the gaming community, has grown and this has had a big impact on the social isolation.

Although you may not see the other players which you are playing with or against, but you are still able to talk to them and communicate with them. That being said, it still means that the user is still sat alone at home with no physical human interaction.

Overall, the social isolation of playing video games wouldn't cause complete isolation with human communication and the ability to befriend others. However, the lack of physical interaction could have some psychological effect on the person, especially if the person is already introverted.

Cost

Cost can be another massive concern, a lot of gamers tend to spend a lot of money on games and in games content, surveys show that an average gamer spends over 300 pounds on games and in game contents in a year.

Let alone the costs for a PC gamer, with computers which are optimised for games coming in at heavy budgets. For instance, a low-end gaming PC would cost around £300-£500, Medi um-end costing £600-800 and a high-end computer costing £1000 and significantly more.

Even for console gamers it could come in at longer term expenses when compared to PC gamers. For instance, the newest PS4 or Xbox One consoles cost around £400-500, which is already a high price for video games. However, videogames for console usually cost a lot more than PC gamers. With PC gamers using the popular software "Steam" for their purchase of video games, they usually come at a cheap price, unless it's a newly released triple A game

In retrospect, video games were an issue when dealing with excessive amounts of money, which made some people consider whether it could be used towards better use, which can cause feelings of regret.

Microtransactions are also very dangerous in the word of gaming. For example, people are able to buy either in game currency or in game items for real money these games tend to be pay to win but this is not always the case and opening a pack or crate with a random result for real money is very similar to gambling.

Overall, playing games can be very expensive, especially if you are a gamer who has to have the best of everything. For instance, when a console is released a player will buy it or when the next console is released they will want to buy the next one.

A majority of people cannot afford this type of hardware for their video games, which sometimes gets themselves into debt. This can be catastrophic as it can stay with them forever if it isn't sorted, sometimes leaving it to last a lifetime.

<u>Benefits for the Individual</u>

Brain training / Hand-eye coordination / Thinking and strategy skills

The reason these three potential impacts are together is due to the fact they closely relate to each other, causing somewhat similar physiological effects on the user due to hand-eye coordination, thinking and strategy skills falling under the brain training benefits for the individual.

There are a few games that help improve a user's brain capabilities, whether it is intentional or not. For instance, some games allow the player to concentrate on a certain number of entities on the screen and uses different skills for the game.

One of these brain capabilities is the hand-eye coordination. To elaborate, it is proven that when playing games, a part of your brain which is involved in eye coordination, is used when playing games. Meaning that that part of the brain is getting some sort of “exercise”, improving that part of the brain.

For example, when playing a standard first person shooter, such as the infamous “Call of Duty” franchise, and the player wants to get from point A to point B, while in a combat situation. The player typically won’t have to look down unto the controller to look for the keys required on a keyboard, or the buttons and movement of a thumbstick required for a controller, as their brain already knows where it is, so it’s basically an automatic coordination.

Away from video games, hand eye coordination is typically used and proven to be beneficial in sporting performance, playing a musical instrument (especially when reading musical notes while playing an instrument), typing, and even exercising. These skills can be obtained or improved by playing video games.

Also, games give an interface at the end of the game on how well the player did, giving them the ability to improve on their skills and compare the previous score. For instance, a lot of indie games tend to have puzzles to unlock certain levels or paths to a game.

A good example of this is the well known “Portal” franchise by “Valve”. Where the entire game is based on increasingly complex puzzles made for the confusion of the player. These type of puzzles gives the gamer better problem solving skills and even changing perspectives on certain situations, which is usually beneficial.

There are also games which are purely strategic, making the player think about the future, the present, how the past has affected the present and how it will affect the future. Making them improve on their decision making skills.

One example of this is the well known “Total War” franchise, which is purely based on military and political strategy. Usually made to be realistic, a player has a choice to pick a country or a form of territory. The player will spend the rest of that playthrough figuring out how they can improve their nation’s military, political and economic power and which way they can achieve

the best possible outcome. It's these type of complex and difficult games that require thinking strategic methods to play.

However, there are some games which require precision and speed, making decisions in a very short space of time, knowing when to hold off and when to go out for an attack. There are many games that are strategy based. For example, the very well known "Starcraft" franchise by "Blizzard", which is known to be a very difficult game due to the extremely fast paced real time strategy aspect.

Typically, the game entails the player to use a specific number of troops to attack and defeat the other player's stronghold, you will need to choose the right type of troops and ensure that you place them in the best possible place to see if they can win.

When a user plays a game, they usually have to use high levels of concentration to ensure they are pressing the right buttons at the correct time, especially when playing extremely difficult games such as the "Dark Souls" franchise.

Overall, the more they player does any activity, the better they are going to get at that activity, which puts some truth to the "practise makes perfect" phrase. However, if the individual is playing a compulsive amount of video games, the individual would not be able to use these type of skills outside of gaming.

Knock On Effect on Society

Families

Video games can have both a positive and negative impact on families. Family is usually thought to have negative impacts since video games are seen to only require one person playing alone on the computer or console. Which is sometimes true, but there are certain video games and even consoles which can benefit the family.

The positive impact it can have on families is the family spending time together playing video games, on consoles such as the "Wii" by Nintendo. This is a good console to spend time with the family because it required the player to move their body in order to interact with the game world, hence why "Wii Sports" is a popular game on the console.

With these type of video games, which require body movement and can have more than one player, the family and even friends can spend time together playing video games, while getting exercise at the same time.

However, there are also negative impacts video games can have on families, since most video game consoles requiring one or two people sitting down, let alone PC gamers which only require one person to play video games on.

Since there are these type of games and platforms to play on, which are very popular in today's market, they are usually isolated from the rest of the family.

This has a negative effect on the player to the rest of the family, since the player may be too focused on video games to talk to the family.If the player isn't playing video games, it might mean that he/she is too busy with work to talk with the family, or he/she might just be bored and doesn't spend the quality time with family due to low energy.

This can also have negative psychological effects on everyone on the family, not only the person playing the games. The reason it effects everyone is due to the player, being their son/daughter, isn't spending time with the family, which can make the parents and siblings feel like they aren't interesting or wanted by that individual, since gaming is a higher priority.

Overall, video games can prove to be a positive and a negative for the family, it just depends on the type of game and console that is on the household or that is being played constantly. With games that require movement and can contain a lot of player playing at once being good for the family to spend time together, and games which only require one person sitting on a chair and using a controller or keyboard being isolated from everyone including the family.

Businesses

There are businesses that can both have beneficial and negative effects from video games, such as video game companies, news companies and businesses looking for employment. Which is also not commonly thought about when playing video games, but it can have both benefit and disadvantages to the businesses.

The positive impact it can have on businesses, such as the gaming business is the consumer buying the products off the video game companies, which is beneficial especially for popular video game companies.

News companies can also benefit from this, with the promotion of video games giving the news company more traction and respect by the gaming community, which is an extremely large community.

With companies selling and supporting video games, which would gain traction and sales by the consumers of the video games, the business can benefit from the popularity. Meaning that the company would make more profits, and create better games and advertisements to attract more people.

However, this are also brings negative impacts video games can have on businesses, since video games are extremely popular, it becomes much more easy for a video game to miss the expectations, causing massive controversy.

Putting the video game company in a bad position, and the news company changing the relations on the video game company, which can have some negative views from the consumer, such as different perspective on both companies, and the negative views on how they see the customers.

There are also other negative effects, which is the popular video game companies being able to manipulate a lot of it's fanbase. They can do this due to the large fanbase they have and how easy it is for a video game to manipulate the players emotions.

So, If the player is on the side with their favourite video game company, the new game that they are planning on releasing may be less of quality than the one before, but it will still be purchased since the fanbase would always love a new game. Leaving those criticising the fact the game is worse, such as game news companies, to be criticised back by the fanbase because they are sided with the video game company.

This can also have negative psychological effects on companies looking for employment, not only businesses focusing around video games. The reason it affects these companies is due to some of the player's addiction to the video games.

Meaning that they might not perform well on the job, or that newer employees may not perform as well because they might be focusing on video games, leaving them sleep deprived or just lazy to work.

Which can make the company replace the employee due to the employee not carrying out the job.Since there are more people playing video games these days, this might become a common problem since people can get very addicted to some video games.

Overall, video games can prove to be a positive and a negative for businesses, it just depends what type of business it is and whether the employee of a business is addicted to video games, meaning that they are sleep deprived or just not making enough work.

However, video games are also very profitable for business which focus around video games. Such as video game companies, news companies and other business which advertise these video games.

The health service

The health service is probably the last thing people will think about when talking about video games, but video games can impact on the health service both beneficially and negatively. Just like the previous two, most people don't think about the health service when talking about video games, but it does have an effect on them which is sometimes not noticed by a lot of people.

The positive impact it can have on the health service, is that with video games, the health service can study the effects on video games, and see if they are a positive effect or negative effect on the brain. With video games giving the getting more traction, the health service can get involved in the psychological and even physical effects that video games give to an individual.

With video games being proven to benefit the brain, the health service could use this information to recommend that videogames are actually good for thinking, meaning that they can understand how the brain works more.

However, this are also brings negative impacts video games can have on the health service, since the health service is responsible for the health of their patients, it becomes a lot easier for a video game to miss the expectations, causing massive controversy.

Putting the health service in a bad position, especially when dealing with the fact that they fail to comprehend video game addiction, or other issues related to video games, giving both the health service and video games a bad image.

So, If the majority of players are experiencing negative effects from video games, the health service is forced to look into the problem to reduce this negative effect that comes from video games.

Leaving those criticising the fact the health service for poor health care for the patients affected with the negative effects of video games, such as addiction, making the study much more stressful to carry out, or that it isn't possible to carry out tests on the effects, leaving the health service in a bad position.

Overall, video games can prove to be a positive and a negative for the health care, but it's for the same reason, which is studying the effects of video games, whether they are beneficial or disadvantageous.

Basically, the health service can benefit from the study of video games if successful, meaning that they can learn more about the brain, mind and whether video games are actually bad for people.

However, if the health service fail to study the effects of video games, they will struggle to understand video game addiction and other negative effects, meaning that they will be criticised by the population.

Task 2

(U22:P2) - Describe different types of computer game

Task description - *For three games, the following:*

1. *Explain the main characteristics of each genre.*
2. *Explain what platform/environment the game is designed to be played on.*
3. *Name a game which is an example of this genre and explain why the game fits into the genre.*

Role-playing games

A role playing game or a RPG is a game where you can customize your character to be the way you want the to look and you can also in some RPG's you can also make the character into either a good character or a bad character and you can decide the actions they take.

The environment the game is typically played on an open world map, leaving the player to explore the world for certain objectives to gain experience, to level up the character. It also typically has a story behind the game, leaving the player to find out more about the story throughout the game, which can be done online or offline.

A good example of this is the game “Fallout”, where it allows you to customize almost everything with the character. What I mean when I say nearly everything is you can customise your weapons, armour, companions and you can even make your own towns.

It fits the genre well because it is extremely open world game, with a good story and character customisation. It also contains objectives to carry out throughout the game, whether it is main story mission or side quests. Where the player finds out more about the game mechanics and the story of the Fallout franchise.

Overall, I feel that Fallout fits the role play game genre well because it has the basics of a role playing game, such as the open world map, the objectives giving experience to the character for leveling up and the objectives being linked to the story.

However, it also has some extra aspects which makes it unique when compared to other role playing games, such as the genre of Fallout, the in depth character customisation, the unique story and the original game setting.

Strategy games

There is a genre of game called strategy game this genre make you think really hard because you would need to think no only you moves but also what your opponent would be doing this is a hard genre of games a great example would be chess on windows file games this game made you think of your and your opponents moves.

The environment the game is typically played on a simple interface, such as a 2D map of a world or a 3D environment of terrain. Leaving the player to carry out what is needed within the game, typically running a military or a country. Since the strategy genre is so broad, that a variety of games fall under the strategy genre.

It also typically realistic to historical events or fictional events, leaving the player to be immersed within the strategic accuracy of the game. Usually, strategy games feature a complex system or skill tree to level up the player’s country or military.

A good example of this is the game is the strategy game “Hearts of Iron 4”, where it allows you to choose a desired country within the year 1936, just before WW2. Making the player choose what they do the the country and it’s military before, during and after WW2. Manipulating the events of the world, seeing the outcome each time.

It fits the genre well because it is a game which is set in a world map of 1936 and the countries which existed at the time, making it very historically accurate. Also, it features a very complex system for the type of government ideology, diplomacy, military and geography.

Overall, I feel that “Hearts of Iron 4” fits the strategy game genre well because it has the basics of a strategy game, such as 2D view for the world map, the complex skill trees of economy, government ideology and military technology.

Hearts of Iron 4 is a standard strategy game, meaning that it has nothing more and nothing less than a strategy game needs. Visually, the game is simple, but with gameplay the game is very complex, challenging the player with the hardest strategy methods.

Platformers

There is a genre of game called platform games this game is very simple you have different layers and you have to make it to the end of the layer that is how you complete the game.

The environment the game is typically played on is a 2D map, which is usually very linear, meaning that they can only go one specific direction. This gives very little for the user to explore, unless they go forwards.

It also typically has a very basic story behind the game, making the player understand what to do from the very first level. This type of genre is all very simple due to the fact it is an indie type game genre, so it doesn’t have a very high budget.

An example of a platform game is “Donkey Kong”. This game was very simple in design, since all the player has to do is jump over barrels that were coming towards the player. Then, the player had to make it to the top of the level, with Donkey Kong and what I assume is a princess and complete that level, making the player go up to the next level.

It fits the genre well because it’s a very simple game design, with a very basic story and very simple controls. Since it didn’t have a very high budget, it features a very simple level layout, where the player can maneuver the character, to avoid moving entities in order to reach the final goal.

Overall, I feel that “Donkey Kong” does fit the platformer genre game well due to its simplicity, and the game based off the character maneuvering through a varieties of platforms while dodging moving entities which causes the player to restart the level.

Hence why there isn’t much to talk about the game, since it's so simple in design and the game concept is simple. Which is why platformers are the usual choice for indie developers starting off in the game development world.

Task 3

(U22:D1) - Examine the psychological effects of computer gaming on individuals and society

Task description - *Using Google or another search engine, find and read carefully two significant academic studies on the psychological effect of computer gaming.*

For each of the two studies:

1. Summarise clearly what the study is attempting to determine and explain the statistics that the study is based on.

2. Using the evidence from the study, write up with your own conclusion as to the psychological results of computer gaming.

Ensure that you fully reference your work.

Reference

https://www.psychologytoday.com/blog/in-excess/201512/psychology-and-competitive-gaming

http://www.amplifon.ie/resources/playing-with-your-mind/

Introduction

On my research for the psychological effects of computer games on both individuals and society as a whole, I came across two articles which explain how the use of sound has an impact on the individual players and how the competitiveness of video games has an effect on both the individual and the community of the video game.

With the information I gathered with the two studies, I will be making my own conclusion and other effects on the individual and society that video games give, such as: the peer pressure of video games, the expectations players will have to the video game and its community, whether the video game is actually fun or just addictive and what players could learn from video games.

Since I believe these effects can occur when dealing with the use of sound, due to its manipulation to the player, and especially competition of video games and how it has a psychological effect on every player.

A summary of the research, including statistical basis of the evidence

Use of sound

When a developer is creating a video game, they want the game to feel as aesthetic as possible. So, when dealing with sound design, the use of sound is proven to be very effective and tries to set the ambience within a game.

For instance, the music that is used tends to try and make the user feel some kind of emotion, whether it be sadness, fear, anxiety or just happiness. Essentially, the music used, if done right, can really enhance the user's experience within the game, just like in films, at pivotal or powerful moment within the game the use of music can really manipulate the user's emotions.

Typically, the more intense the part of the game the higher intensity music will be used, whereas if the part of the game was a sad storyline or during a sad scene, slower peaceful sad music would be used. It is what users react to and it is very easy to get the "mood" across without have to show any pictures or the use of words.

As the article quotes: "Amnesia's interactive use of sound not only feeds back to the player - telling them how close they are to insanity, for instance - but drives the overall experience of the game. It's worth noting from a psychological standpoint that a 2012 study at the University of Alberta hooked 12 students up to heart and respiration monitors while playing this game: heart and respiration rates increased by 20 bpm and 13 bpm respectively when audio was switched on."

Overall, The use of sound can be very effective through the use of games and can allow a user to feel genuine sadness, happiness or fear depending on which emotion they are aiming for, making sound one very manipulative tool that most people tend to ignore about video games.

Even though sound is a very simple and easily ignored aspect of a videogame, the sound design is actually very detailed and complex, due to their ability impact on the player's emotions and how it makes a game feel more genuine, and game developers know this. So most video game developers prioritise sound for their games.

Competitiveness

Competition is a very large part in everyone's lives, it is found in every walk of life where people are rivalling themselves against each other to see who is the better. This is no different when it comes to gaming. Almost every online game will have some form of PVP (Player vs. Player), where opponents are able to test their skills on one another and see who the victor is.

Not only is this a good way to determine the skill level of a player but it can also point out areas of the game which may need to be improved. Having worthy competition would force a player to either stay ahead of the game or raise their game to be able to beat the opponent.

There are competitive events that are ran for “elite” players these players are the best of the best and usually compete for a prize fund, that being said the amount of time the users will be playing may have adverse effects and make the user socially reclusive.

As the article quotes: “When video game players are capable of financially supporting themselves from their play, this matter becomes more complex. For example, how would one categorize a professional video game player who was making over $100,000 per year playing video games, but was also experiencing social difficulties as a result of excessive video game use?”

The games that tend to be played on big game machines have leader boards, once the user has paid they would be credited with a certain number of credits, once the credit has been depleted their score would get posted to a leaders board and this was be ranked with other users who have played the game.

To get the best score the machine would coerce you into buying more credit to either buy a new set of lives or try again to attempt to beat the other people on the leaderboard.

Having leaderboards in games it drives and motivates the player to be the best or just keep improving, a good game to demonstrate this would be the “Guitar Hero” franchise. All of their games will give you a score for each song depending on which difficulty you play on. It also depends how much score the player would be able to get, this would also force people to try and advance to the next difficulty to earn more points to try and get higher up the table.

Short term leader boards would be found on a plethora of games. More often than not, when playing first person shooter games, pausing the game tends to bring up a menu in which you will be able to navigate to the scoreboard and can see your stats for the current game, this would be able to tell a user how well they are doing in that specific game.

On the other hand, if you are lower in the list for example 450th out of 500 you may seem unmotivated through looking at the number one high score. Which can either cause the person to give up and waste all that time spent playing the game, or to spend more time trying to become even better than they are currently.

As the article quotes: “Relative leaderboards try to solve this issue by showing a user's position relative to others of a similar rank. So, whilst you may be 900th out of 1000, you only see the 10 people above and below you on the leaderboard. This means that you don’t get the issue of feeling inadequate or that there is no hope of ever reaching the top – you are less aware of how far down the list you are!”

Overall, competition in video games can be disadvantageous to a person’s psychological health, due to the competitive nature of most people. Meaning when people see a score that is too high, they may become demotivated.

This is tough to their psychological health as they realise that they are never going to be able to beat that score. In addition to this, it explains only seeing a short list shows that you can aim to beat the players around you and then move on to face the players above this way the size of the task is much smaller and psychologically it makes the user much more relaxed.

Your own conclusions, using the evidence from the study

While looking at these studies, I have come up with my own conclusions with the effects that videogame competitiveness and emotional manipulation with tools such as sound can do to the player and the community of an entire game.

First off, the competitive nature of some video games can cause peer pressure, whether it is intentional or not, due to the fun and sometimes addictive aspect of video games.

However, it can arise in different situations, for example it could be a friend buying a game, exclaiming about how great it is or how they are in need of teammates, this would then in turn make people unhappy as they don't have the game, some people may not be able to afford it but would but it anyway and then be stuck in financial struggles.

Peer pressure within the gaming industry can be very dangerous, it is not always intentionally done but may be subliminally transferred to a gamer as more responsibilities are gained, for example when playing on online games, gamers to band together and join groups of people this could be as a tribe or a guild, so they can increase their competitiveness with a team.

Some gamers may take up upon themselves to put in extra hours for the team that they are in this can lead to playing too much and feeling like you would be letting the team down if you were not to continue player and put a certain amount of hours in, or contributing enough money or resources to the team, inadvertently this would cause peer pressure without any physical pressuring.

This is particularly important for so called “guilds”. Guilds are longer-lived player associations which are needed to achieve goals in games such as “World of Warcraft”, guilds also exist in other online games and multiplayer games.

Obviously, highly committed players play more than others who feel less committed to their guild, which means that guilds put a sense of social pressure on their members. Furthermore, it can be concluded that these guilds have unwritten norms. Arrangements will be made between members of guilds so that the members have to be online at a certain time.

Which brings me onto the leveling aspect to video games, especially games which have a competitive community.

Basically, leveling can have a big effect on the psychology of a player. For example, the player will start off at the base level whether it just be level one or the retrospective level, it will give the player a purpose, the player will be able to gain expected and level up their character and gain new skills and abilities and obtaining rewards.

This will keep a player interested and will continue to enjoy the game. Once a player is top the top of the levelling system they tend to lose motivation that need something to continuously work towards.

Similar to the leaderboards, the players want to be the highest level. They want to have the most money and better items than all the other players this shows the player is significant in the game and help gives the player a feeling of belonging.

Which then brings this to the debate whether video games are actually fun or just addictive due to the emotional manipulation. However**,** the usual reason a lot of gamers play games is that they find them fun, intriguing and interesting. Not because they are addicted to the video game, but there are some who are addicted to video games.

On one hand,there are a few different reason people may find a game fun; this could be due to cooperating with others, competitiveness with others, in depth well told storylines and the actual gameplay available to the gamer.

Essentially, there are people tend to play games as a form of winding down and relaxing they aren't "hard core" gamers and will just play a few hours a week when they have spare time. Games give a different experience than just watching a film, the game is more interactive in many instances the gamer can feel themselves in the player's shoes.

However, on the other hand, the competitiveness with others, or the thrill of the many emotions experienced within a game, can cause some addictive habits to the player. Which can cause the player to be so immersed within the game that reality would sometimes be forgotten, which can sometimes feed more to the addiction of video games.

The type of people who are addicted to video games, are either addicted because they want to be better in the competitive scene or the manipulation of emotions through sound, graphics and good writing gets them really immersed into video games, making them feel like they are a part of that world because it is a very well made game.

However, that isn't always the case with video games. Which brings me onto the expectations that people have for video games. What I mean by this is when a game is being developed, masses of media is created to give gamers an idea of how the game looks and maybe some glimpses to the storyline.

During the development process the developing team try to have some secrets that than have developed into the game for example a plot twist and a certain major character being killed, which can have a massive emotional impact with the people looking forward to getting the game.

Which is why expectations for a video game can have emotional manipulation, just like the sound and music in games, which can put the audience into a certain “mood” and create some ambience.

For example, a character than has been present throughout the game has been a main part with an in depth storyline could be killed off and leave the audience in shock, which can cause both controversy and wonder for the continuation of the video game.

When expectations are drawn up they tend to be based on other games either previous in the franchise or games that may be similar to the game that is being developed. Which can be very risky for the game developer, since people might be expecting for more a game than it’s actually offering.

When developers are creating a game, it is important to ensure you give the user a unique experience this would mean having a unique selling point, which will make sure that your will be engraved in the minds of gamers by having something special.

The expectation of video games can also have an educational aspect to them, such as historical events, true facts about life or information which is either subtle or really obvious within the video game but factual, such as economy, politics and logic.

Which finally brings me to the educational value of video games, which is sometimes not thought about when people talk about video games, and for some who do know either realise that it is a good learning tool or decide to not believe it.

It is widely accepted that many students learn in different ways, some through taking notes, some through being explained in a procedural and logical way and some can learn through the use of games.

If the game developers want to make the game educational intentionally, then education can be incorporated within games this is a great way of getting users to learn especially if they have an interest games and that style of game.

However, there are games which can be more educational than the developers realise. Strategy games which focus on historical wars, city building or even controlling people living in their own homes, can educate the player and sometimes give them a different perspective on life.

Also, games can be used to help deliver a point or method. For instance, games which focus on historical events, such as the world wars, can prove to the player how horrible war could really be, and that it is possibly the most immoral thing. Unless the game glorifies war which is apparent to some action games, which can also cause some psychological effects.

In addition to these games can be used as icebreakers and to attempt to try and get a group working together with a fun aspect, and were also more effective for children who started out with relatively poor skills.Which can improve the education of those who aren't capable of learning in a calm, quiet or what they would consider boring environment.

Some evidence suggests that important skills may be built or reinforced by videogames. For example, spatial visualization ability (i.e., mentally, rotating and manipulating two- and three-dimensional objects) improves with video game playing.

Overall, I believe that videogames can have positive physiological effects on a person, such as better thinking and brain coordination, better knowledge on what the video games are based on and even a better perspective on some things in life.

However, there are some controversial debated whether video games desensitise people. I believe that they do desensitise certain questionably moral actions, such as war and killing,m but only on a virtual screen.

For example, I believe that people who play video games can tolerate violence better than the average person when shown on a screen. However, if the violence personally affects them, they realise the effect of the violence or if they personally experience the violence, they would be extremely disturbed and even traumatised, which is a natural human emotion to go through when experiencing these issues.

However, there are some certain mental problems which can cause the lack of empathy to war, violence and pain to others, but they are considered as psychopathy and sociopathy, meaning that they already lacked the feelings of morality. So, all video games would do to people who suffer this physiological problem, is show them how people are harmed with violence.

All in all, I believe that videogames do not affect the average person, unless they were addicted to a game to a point where they suffer health issues, and that people who suffer psychological issues learn to be violent with video games.